

As I walked down the street I could feel all eyes pierce right through my soul, as if I had taken their belongings away from them. Though it was them who did it. They took away my tranquillity, the reputation I built for myself out of the hard work I did.

It all started when I was at a family gathering with my ex-husband. I don't know why they say 'my' when referring to ex.

Some women were sitting across from me tittle-tattling the news that got out, that I can not conceive even though I had been married for over three years. Which was true.

I was getting sick of listening to that tedious twaddle, I needed to spice things up a bit.

"Oh my God, so I am the crux of your blabber yet again ain't I?" putting up my best cooperative smile. "Well now let me verify the rumours, they are one hundred percent genuine. Yes, I can't conceive, so what? It's none of your concern, it's not like you'll help me in the upbringing of the children. Plus even if I don't feel like having children with Jaleel, his genes are not good enough. And you know what, he still wets himself till this age."

I turned toward Jaleel who stood motionless, unable to say anything, "You will be getting the divorce papers in a few days, I am off." I wave and walk out.

Jaleel had always been like that, never stood up for me when the rumours went about. He only married me to work as a baby-making machine carrying on his 'esteemed' lineage. Because I am a woman from a good background I was befitting for it.

The divorce matters were resolved well, allowing me to return to work and regain a sense of normalcy in my life quite a bit, except for some talk which was fine I guess. I was finally free from seeing that guy every day, it was such a pain to tolerate him.

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One day an old friend of my mother Miss Shamim Ansari came over for dinner.

"How is it going, child?" she referred to me.

But my mother cut in "Ramisha is doing pretty well at her workplace and even got a promotion."

"That is great, may God bless you with all his blessings," she smiled.

The rest of it went well. We had a meal and then talked over tea. There was a bell on the door so I went over to check.

"Who is it?", I called out.

"I have come to take a nanny with me." the person behind the door answered.

"Nanny who?"

"Miss Shamim."

I remembered that she did say someone was going to receive her. I opened the door to let him in and led him to the drawing room where everyone was seated.

On seeing the guest, Miss Shamim introduced him, "This is Sarim, the kid I nannied."

"It's nice to meet you all", Sarim greeted.

My father introduced everyone in response " This is your nanny's friend, I am her husband Khalid Adeel and this is Ramisha our daughter, my son is still away."

After the guests had left my mother told me that Sarim's mother left his father to marry another man. Which broke him and his father. I did not pay much attention to it.

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I came back from work when I heard, "I hope you consider this proposal", walking by the door where Miss Shamim was there with my parents.

I went to the kitchen where my brother was cleaning up, "help me, here", he called out.

"So you are getting a marriage proposal huh? Congratulations, I thought no one would take interest in you but idiots do exist."

"Who said it was for me?"

I nearly choked.

"It's for you."

I did not know what to say

Later I was called. "We got a marriage proposal for you", dad told me.

"Everyone knows about my condition, still..."

"He is fine with it. Do consider it. We think this is a good proposal but the final decision will be yours previously, we decided for you and it was not right so it is all up to you now." Mom gave me a pained smile.

They finally understood that at times even parents make wrong decisions for their children.